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China Utilities & Renewables Blog

Widening European peak-trough power price gap into 4Q26; GCL Tech proposed to acquire LFP business; CLP's 9M26 update

APAC Utilities & Renewables | Sustainable Investing

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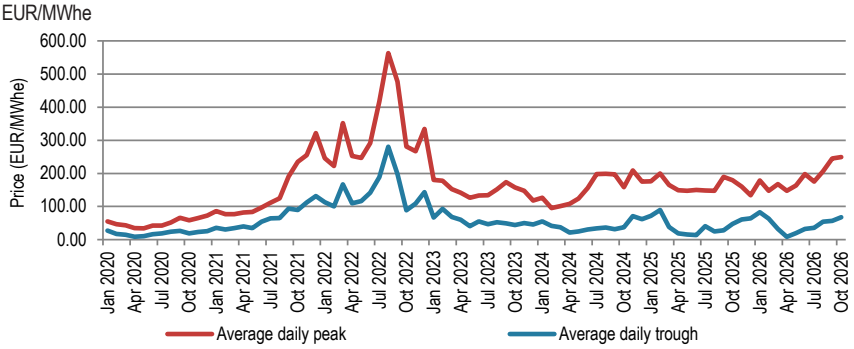
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The European peak-trough power price gap further widened in September and October, strengthening the case for ESS. The duck curve across major European markets continues to deepen into 4Q26, with widening intraday spreads and more frequent negative-price hours as growing solar penetration depresses midday prices, while tighter evening net-load conditions support peak pricing. We believe this increasingly volatile power-price environment reinforces a structural shift in value creation from generation to flexibility, improving the long-term investment case for energy storage through arbitrage, ancillary services and other flexibility markets, and supporting continued ESS deployment across Europe. We have OW ratings on **Sungrow (300274 CH)** and **Deye (605117 CH)**. We like Deye as a beneficiary of accelerating DG ESS adoption across emerging markets and Europe. For Sungrow, while the share price has been weak due to concerns around the US Executive Order, we believe fundamentals remain solid and risk/reward is skewed to the upside on the back of robust global ESS (energy storage system) demand.

Figure 1: European power market: Monthly average daily peak and trough px



Source: Ember Energy.

GCL Tech: Proposed LFP acquisition strengthens second-growth-pillar thesis. GCL Tech has signed a non-binding MOU to acquire an 81.9% stake in Sichuan GCL Lithium Battery Technology for a preliminary Rmb2.5bn consideration, adding a profitable and fully utilized LFP cathode materials business to its platform. Management highlighted the deal as a means to accelerate the commercialization of high-compaction LFP technology and expand effective LFP capacity to ~400kt in the near term, supported by long-term supply agreements exceeding 1mn tonnes through 2028. We view the transaction positively, as it could accelerate earnings diversification beyond polysilicon and make the company's LFP strategy more tangible. Given the target's Rmb620mn 2027-28 profit commitment and modest potential share dilution (~5%), we do not expect the transaction to be earnings-dilutive, while reinforcing GCL Tech's transition toward a broader new-energy materials platform. We maintain our OW rating on **GCL Tech (3800 HK)**.

CLP: Businesses in Hong Kong SAR and Mainland China remained stable, while Australia remains the key swing factor. CLP's 9M26 operating update was

See page 12 for analyst certification and important disclosures, including non-US analyst disclosures.

broadly in line with expectations. Hong Kong electricity sales increased 2.5% YoY, to 28.1TWh, driven by stronger commercial and infrastructure demand, partly offset by a 1.4% decline in residential consumption. In Mainland China, nuclear operations remained stable, with higher generation at Daya Bay, while CLP has commissioned 575MW of new wind capacity YTD. Although renewable generation was affected by higher curtailment and weaker wind and solar resources, management noted some signs of improving supply-demand dynamics in the renewable market, with average tariffs declining only marginally YoY. In Australia, lower wholesale power prices and reduced market volatility weighed on generation margins, while customer accounts declined 5% YoY and retail margins softened following tariff reductions from July. Overall, stable contributions from Hong Kong and Mainland China continue to offset a softer earnings backdrop in Australia, which remains the key swing factor for group earnings.

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Table 1: Top stock ideas

Company	Ticker	Rating	Current price	PT(LC)	Upside/ (Downside)	Investment thesis/ Key Catalysts
Top Long						
Sungrow	300274 CH	OW	76.0	140.0	84%	Riding on robust global ESS demand, while AIDC ESS development could be an emerging catalyst
Deye	605117 CH	OW	70.2	154.0	119%	(1) Riding the strong DG ESS growth in EM; (2) Beneficiary of disruption and tailwinds from energy resilience; (3) First mover in EM + cost leadership
Orient Cables	603606 CH	OW	34.1	52.0	52%	Benefitting from China's offshore wind demand pickup, as well as submarine cable's (1) high entry barriers, (2) stable competitive landscape, (3) strong profitability
Dajin-H	1081 HK	OW	22.5	43.0	91%	Well-positioned to benefit from accelerating European offshore wind demand and potential foundation supply tightness
Goldwind-H	2208 HK	OW	7.5	12.0	60%	WTG business may continue to improve, on the back of rising export sales and stronger-than-expected GPM
ENN Energy	2688 HK	OW	49.2	57.0	16%	>6% dividend yield with at least stable DPS. ENN's LNG contracts and help protect its dollar margin amid rising LNG and piped gas prices
Top Avoid						
Tongwei	600438 CH	UW	11.3	8.8	(22%)	Multi-year polysilicon downcycle, loss-making in 2025, and unattractive valuation
Maxwell	300751 CH	UW	142.8	120.0	(16%)	Declining HJT cell equipment order intakes in the last two years, unclarities on future order outlook, and unattractive valuation

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P., J.P. Morgan estimates. All prices as of 20 October 2026 market close.

Figure 2: 3Q26 earnings calendar

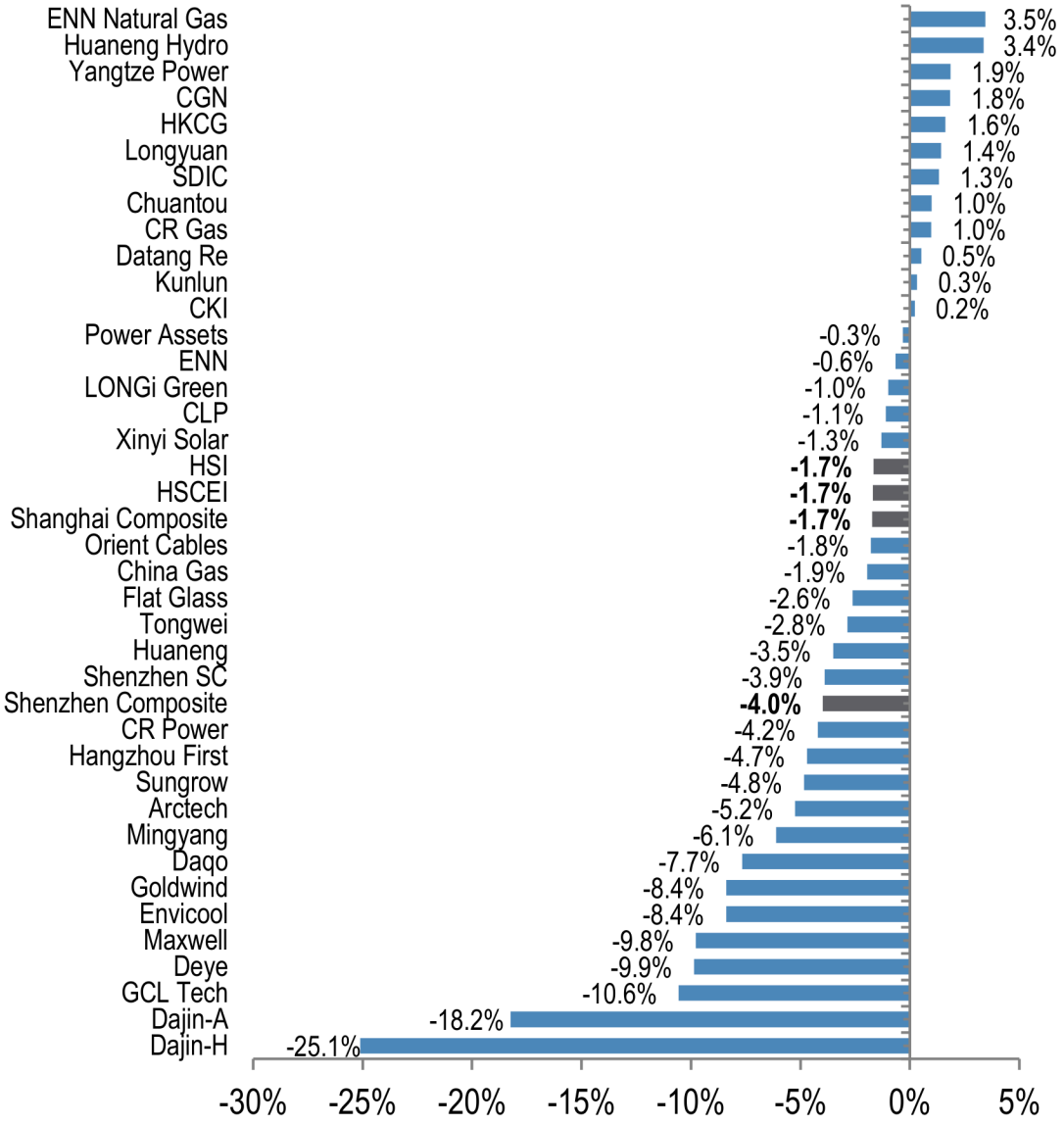
3Q26 Results Calendar

19-Oct	20-Oct	21-Oct	22-Oct	23-Oct	24-Oct	25-Oct
				Goldwind 2208 HK		Huaneng Hydro 600025 CH
26-Oct	**27-Oct**	**28-Oct**	**29-Oct**	**30-Oct**	**31-Oct**	**1-Nov**
HZ First 603806 CH	Maxwell 300751 CH	Ningbo Orient 603606 CH	Deye 605117 CH	Flat Glass 6865 HK		
Dajin Heavy 002487 CH	Arctech 688408 CH	CGN Power 1816 HK	SZ SE 300724 CH	Tongwei 600438 CH		
Envicool 002837 CH	Daqo DQ US		Longyuan 916 HK	Mingyang 601615 CH		
	Huaneng Power 902 HK		Datang Renewable 1798 HK	Sungrow 300274 HK		
				LONGi Green 601012 CH		
				China Yangtze Power 600900 CH		
				ENN NG 600803 CH		

Source: SSE, SZSE, HKEx, Company announcements.

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Figure 3: HK/CH utilities' one-week performance



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. All prices as of 20 October 2026 market close, except for DQ US, priced as of 19 October 2026. Note: Past performance is not an indicator of future results.

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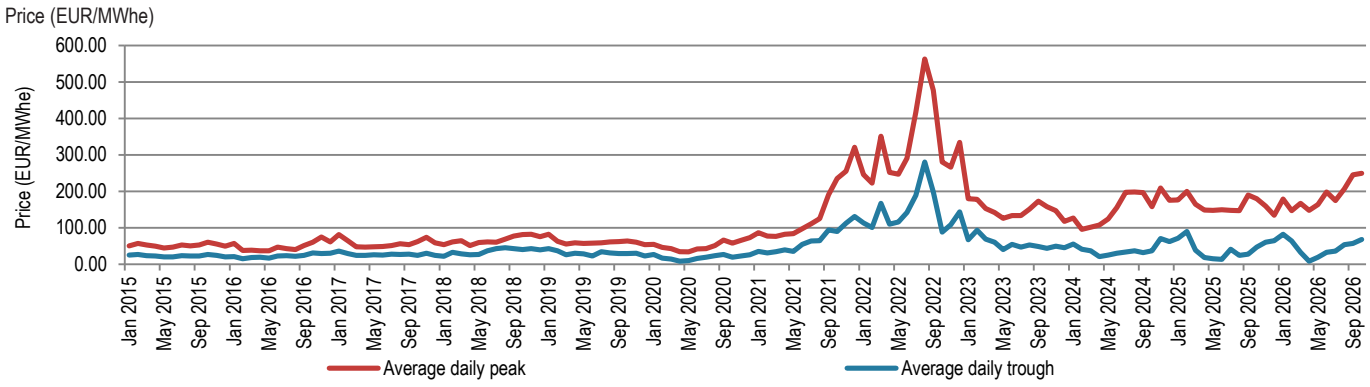
European power price analysis: Widening intraday spreads strengthen the case for ESS

We have highlighted in prior reports (link, link) that the duck curve in major European power markets is becoming increasingly pronounced. Our latest analysis suggests that the trend has continued into 2026, with average daily peak prices rising more sharply than trough prices across many European markets, resulting in wider intraday price spreads and a higher frequency of negative-price hours. The widening gap between midday and evening prices reflects a growing mismatch between renewable generation and system demand: Increasing solar penetration continues to push midday prices lower, while evening prices remain supported by tighter net-load conditions, fuel-linked marginal costs and system ramping requirements. While the magnitude varies by market, the trend is visible across major markets, including Germany, Italy, the UK and Austria.

In our view, this points to a structural shift in the power market value pool from generation toward flexibility. Rising intraday volatility increases the value of assets that can shift electricity across time, creating a more supportive environment for ESS. Storage operators can monetize these dynamics through energy arbitrage, ancillary services, demand response and peak-shaving applications. Although power price spreads should not be viewed as a direct proxy for ESS project returns, given the importance of local market design and operating strategy, we believe the underlying price signals are becoming increasingly supportive. As long as intraday spreads remain elevated, European ESS project economics should continue to improve, underpinning the region's long-term ESS deployment growth.

Within the ESS manufacturing space, we have OW ratings on **Sungrow (300274 CH)** and **Deye (605117 CH)**. We like Deye as a beneficiary of accelerating DG ESS adoption across emerging markets and Europe. For Sungrow, while the share price has been weak due to concerns around the US Executive Order and geopolitics, we believe fundamentals remain solid and risk/reward is skewed to the upside on the back of robust global ESS demand.

Figure 4: European power market: Monthly average daily peak and trough px

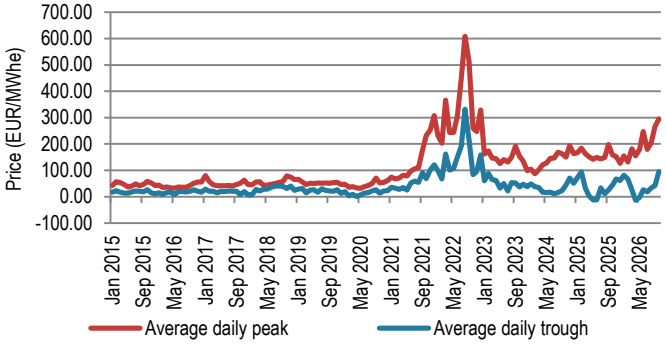


Source: Ember Energy.

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Figure 5: Germany monthly average daily peak and trough px

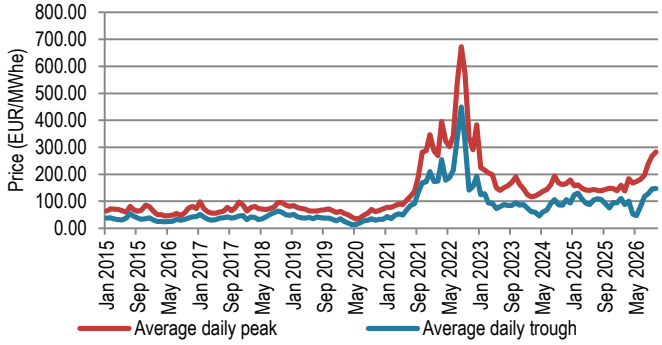
Price (EUR/MWhe)



Source: Ember Energy.

Figure 6: Italy monthly average daily peak and trough px

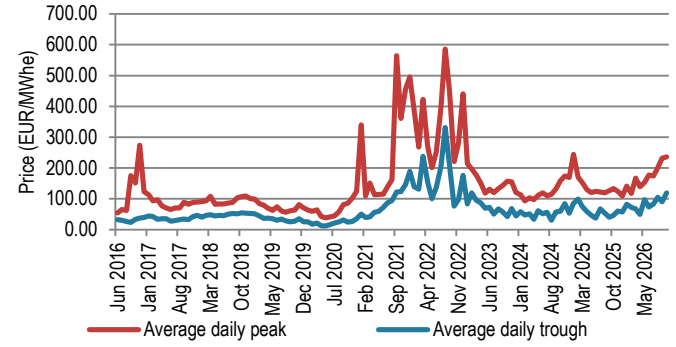
Price (EUR/MWhe)



Source: Ember Energy.

Figure 7: UK monthly average daily peak and trough px

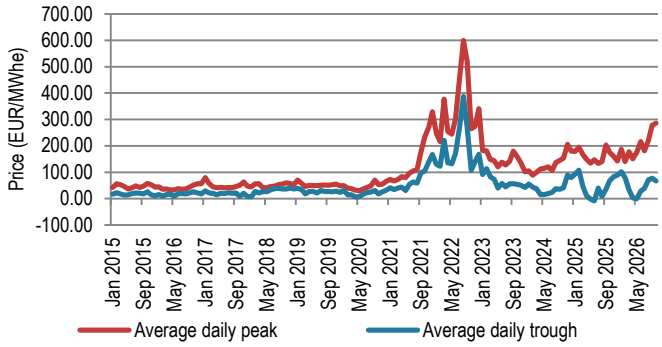
Price (EUR/MWhe)



Source: Ember Energy.

Figure 8: Austria monthly average daily peak and trough px

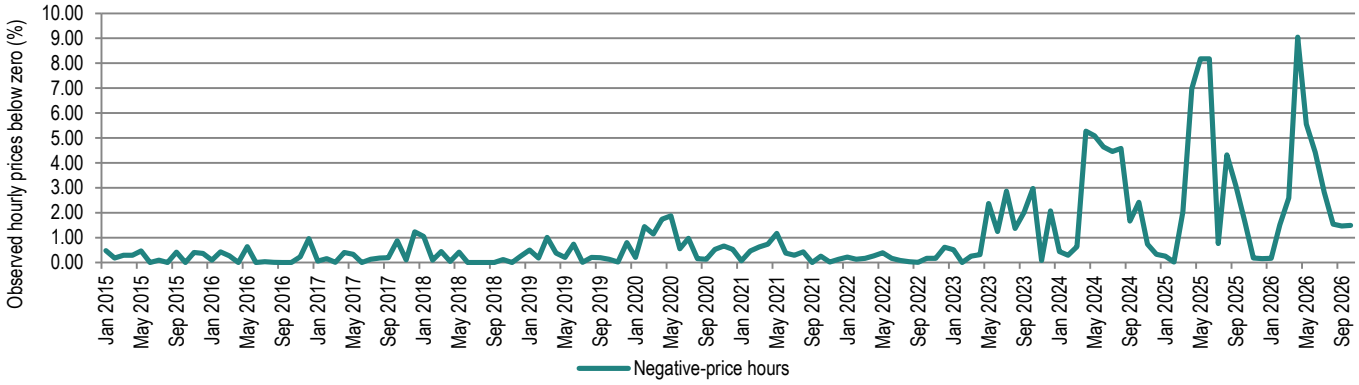
Price (EUR/MWhe)



Source: Ember Energy.

Figure 9: Negative-price frequency across Europe power market

%



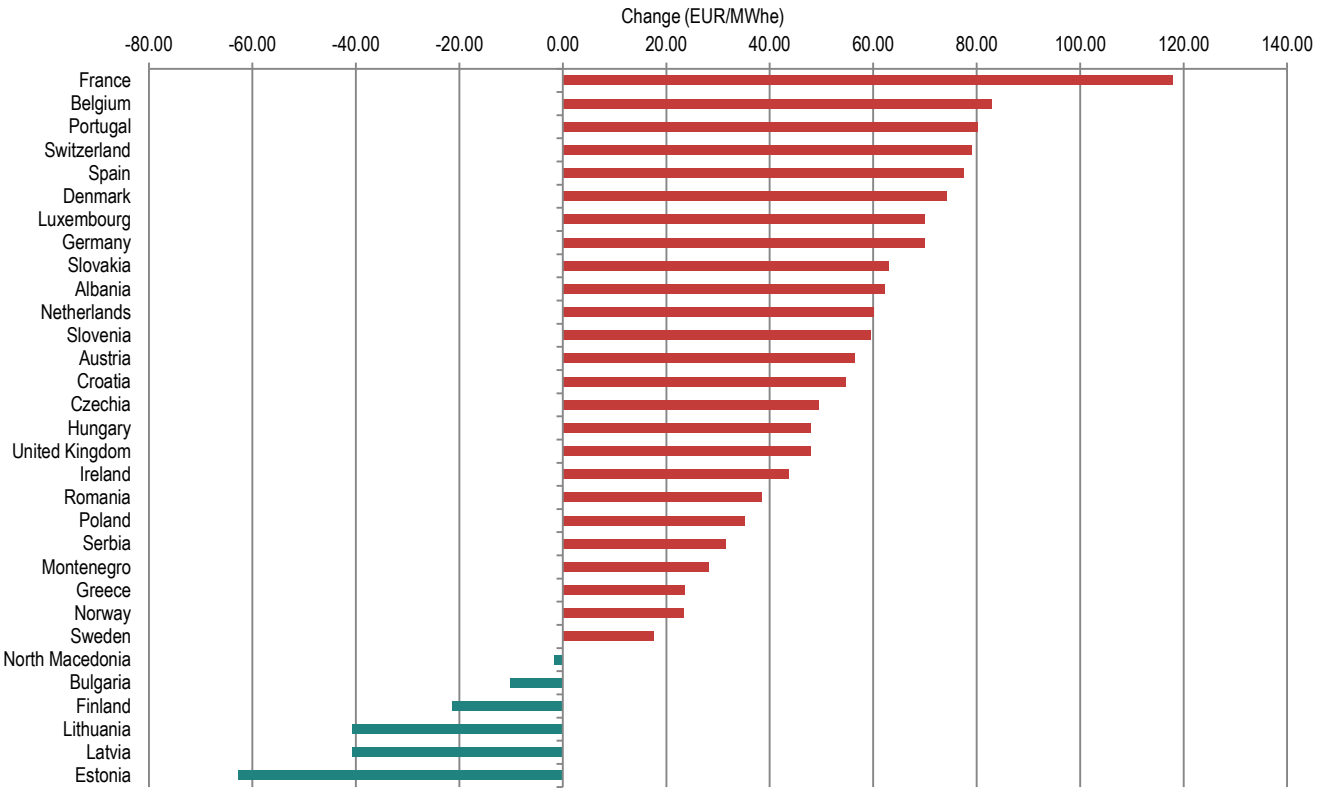
Source: Ember Energy.

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Figure 10: Last-30-day year-on-year spread change

Change (EUR/MWhe)



Source: Ember Energy.

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GCL Tech announced acquisition of Sichuan GCL Lithium Battery Technology

GCL Tech announced on 19 October 2026 (link) that it had signed a non-binding MOU to acquire 81.9% of Sichuan GCL Lithium Battery Technology for a preliminary Rmb2.5bn consideration (Rmb650mn cash plus Rmb1.85bn in new shares). The shares will be issued at no less than HK$1.30/share, implying up to ~1.67bn new shares. The vendor has committed to aggregate adjusted net profit of at least Rmb620mn in 2027-28, and the target is required to develop sixth-generation LFP cathode materials with compaction density above 2.8g/cm³ by end-2028. The transaction remains subject to due diligence, valuation, definitive documentation and relevant approvals.

Management said on an analyst call that the deal is intended to accelerate the commercialization and scale-up of high-compaction LFP technology, rather than simply add capacity. The target is reportedly running at full utilization, with ~150kt effective capacity (vs. ~120kt nameplate) and ~Rmb242mn profit in 1H26. Combined with ~250kt effective capacity at Leshan Phase I, GCL Tech expects ~400kt near-term effective LFP capacity post-acquisition, with Leshan Phase II and further expansions under way. Management also highlighted potential advantages from its iron-oxide process in complexity, energy use and cost as LFP shifts toward higher compaction. On demand, management noted cumulative long-term supply agreements of over 1mn tonnes through 2028, largely covering sales from the ~400kt effective capacity. It expects profitability to be driven mainly by processing fees, process-cost advantages and higher-generation product premiums, rather than lithium-price exposure (with customers currently supplying over 50% of lithium carbonate). Strategically, the deal supports GCL Tech's shift from a polysilicon-led business toward a broader new-energy materials platform, with LFP as a potential second growth pillar.

J.P. Morgan view: We view the proposed acquisition positively, as it could accelerate GCL Tech's buildout of LFP as a meaningful second growth pillar and further diversify earnings beyond polysilicon. Importantly, it would inject an operating, profitable business into the listed platform, potentially shortening the LFP ramp-up. We also see a favorable earnings/dilution profile: First, the target is already profitable and carries an aggregate Rmb620mn 2027-28 adjusted net profit commitment; relative to our combined 2027-28 earnings estimate for GCL Tech of Rmb5.5bn, the 81.9% stake could add over 9% to earnings on a static basis. Second, the maximum new share issuance of ~1.67bn implies ~5% dilution vs. the 1H26 share base. On this basis, we do not expect any earnings dilution in 2027/28. More broadly, the deal makes the LFP optionality highlighted in our prior report (link) more tangible and reinforces GCL Tech's transition toward a broader new-energy materials platform. **We maintain our OW rating**: Our core thesis remains polysilicon cost leadership, with LFP an increasingly meaningful source of diversification and potential upside. Given that the transaction is still a non-binding MOU, we await definitive documentation and additional financial disclosure before reflecting it in our forecasts.

CLP: Businesses in Hong Kong and Mainland China remained stable, while Australia remains the key swing factor

CLP's 9M26 operating update was broadly in line with expectations. Hong Kong electricity sales increased 2.5% YoY, to 28.1TWh, driven by stronger commercial and infrastructure demand, partly offset by a 1.4% decline in residential consumption. In Mainland China, nuclear operations remained stable, with higher generation at Daya

Bay, while CLP has commissioned 575MW of new wind capacity YTD. Although renewable generation was affected by higher curtailment and weaker wind and solar resources, management noted some signs of improving supply-demand dynamics in the renewable market, with average tariffs declining only marginally YoY. In Australia, lower wholesale power prices and reduced market volatility weighed on generation margins, while customer accounts declined 5% YoY and retail margins softened following tariff reductions from July. Overall, stable contributions from Hong Kong and Mainland China continue to offset a softer earnings backdrop in Australia, which remains the key swing factor for group earnings.

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Table 2: Weekly solar component price update

Product	20261014	Change
Polysilicon Price - Prime for Mono (RMB/kg) - quoted PVInfolink	40.00	*0.0%*
Polysilicon Futures Active Contract Closing Price (RMB/kg) - quoted Guangzhou Futures Exchange	34.35	*-6.1%*
Granular Polysilicon Price (Rmb/kg) - quoted PVInfolink	40.00	*0.0%*
Polysilicon Price - Ex-China (Usd/kg) - quoted PVInfolink	18.50	*0.0%*
Mono N-type Wafer - 182*210mm (Rmb/pc) - 130um	1.05	*0.0%*
TOPCon Cell - 182-210mm 25.0%+ (RMB)	0.31	*0.0%*
182*182-210mm/210mm single TOPCon Module - China Utility projects (RMB)	0.71	*0.0%*
182*182-210mm/210mm single TOPCon Module - China DG projects (RMB)	0.74	*0.0%*
182*182-210mmm BC Module - China Utility projects (Rmb/W)	0.77	*0.0%*
182*182-210mmm BC Module - China DG projects (Rmb/W)	0.81	*0.0%*
182mm bi-facial TOPCon Module (RMB)	0.72	*-0.6%*
210mm bi-facial HJT Module (RMB)	0.75	*0.0%*
Solar glass - 3.2mm (RMB / m2)	16.50	*1.2%*
Solar glass - 2.0mm (RMB / m2)	10.35	*1.0%*
General EVA film (RMB / m2)	6.37	*0.0%*
White EVA film (RMB / m2)	6.87	*0.0%*
POE film (RMB / m2)	8.97	*0.0%*
PV grade EVA resin (Rmb/ton)	11,350	*2.3%*
Soda ash (Rmb/ton)	1,150	*0.0%*
Silicon metal (Rmb/ton)	9,590	*0.0%*
Steel scrap (Rmb/ton)	2,420	*0.0%*
Cast iron (Rmb/ton)	3,080	*-1.6%*

Source: PVInfoLink, SMM, WIND, Bloomberg Finance L.P. Note: For EVA resin, soda ash, silicon metal, steel scrap, cast iron, data are as of last working Wednesday.

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Table 3: J.P. Morgan HK/China utilities valuation comparison

Company	Ticker	JPM Rating	JPM PT (Local)	Last price (Local)	Upside (%)	Mkt cap (US$mn)	Avg daily liquidity (US$mn)	P/E (x)		P/B (x)		Yield (%)		Net debt/equity (%)		ROE (%)		EV/EBITDA (x)	
								FY26E	FY27E	FY26E	FY27E	FY26E	FY27E	FY26E	FY27E	FY26E	FY27E	FY26E	FY27E
Hong Kong Utilities																			
CLP	2 HK	N	73.50	76.5	(3.9)	24,610	32.4	16.6	16.1	1.7	1.7	4.2	4.3	50.4	49.2	10.6	10.6	10.9	10.3
HKCG	3 HK	OW	7.75	7.2	7.1	17,201	26.1	21.4	21.0	2.3	2.3	4.8	4.8	74.8	75.1	12.6	12.8	17.0	16.8
PAH	6 HK	OW	62.00	60.3	2.8	16,373	21.0	7.6	20.0	1.3	1.3	4.7	4.7	(42.4)	(41.6)	17.5	6.3	4.9	12.4
CKI	1038 HK	OW	66.00	67.2	(1.7)	21,557	11.0	7.0	20.0	1.2	1.1	3.9	4.0	(24.1)	(23.6)	17.7	5.8	5.6	13.9
Average								***13.2***	***19.3***	***1.6***	***1.6***	***4.4***	***4.5***	***14.7***	***14.8***	***14.6***	***8.9***	***9.6***	***13.3***
China Gas Utilities																			
Kunlun	135 HK	OW	7.60	7.6	0.6	8,298	9.3	10.3	9.9	0.8	0.8	4.9	5.0	(28.0)	(30.6)	7.8	7.8	3.5	3.4
China Gas*	384 HK	N	5.70	5.0	13.2	3,495	9.0	9.5	9.3	0.5	0.5	7.0	7.0	79.2	75.0	5.0	5.0	9.3	9.2
CR Gas	1193 HK	N	16.50	16.5	0.1	4,862	6.9	10.6	10.3	0.8	0.8	5.8	5.8	19.3	13.8	7.9	7.9	6.7	6.5
ENN Energy	2688 HK	OW	57.00	49.2	15.9	7,095	23.1	8.2	8.1	0.9	0.9	6.2	6.2	18.3	15.7	11.5	11.1	5.7	5.6
ENN Natural Gas	600803 CH	OW	21.00	20.1	4.6	9,301	23.1	12.0	9.8	2.3	2.1	4.8	5.1	17.8	11.6	20.2	22.2	7.6	6.6
Average								***10.1***	***9.5***	***1.1***	***1.0***	***5.7***	***5.8***	***21.3***	***17.1***	***10.5***	***10.8***	***6.6***	***6.2***
China Power Utilities																			
Huaneng Power	902 HK	UW	4.80	5.9	(18.8)	15,856	17.4	6.9	7.3	1.0	0.9	5.9	5.5	114.5	95.7	4.5	3.7	9.2	9.0
CR Power	836 HK	N	17.00	19.3	(12.1)	12,751	28.2	7.3	7.5	0.9	0.8	5.5	5.3	164.3	155.8	9.8	8.9	8.1	8.0
Average								***7.1***	***7.4***	***0.9***	***0.9***	***5.7***	***5.4***	***139.4***	***125.7***	***7.1***	***6.3***	***8.7***	***8.5***
China Wind Power																			
China wind farms																			
Datang Renewable	1798 HK	OW	1.25	1.0	29.5	894	1.4	21.5	9.0	0.3	0.3	1.7	4.0	304.2	290.6	1.4	3.2	10.5	14.6
Longyuan	916 HK	OW	7.00	5.3	31.7	13,427	11.5	10.7	9.6	0.5	0.5	3.3	3.8	179.6	168.0	5.6	6.2	8.9	8.1
H-share - Average								**16.1**	**9.3**	**0.4**	**0.4**	**2.5**	**3.9**	**241.9**	**229.3**	**3.5**	**4.7**	**9.7**	**11.4**
China wind equipment makers																			
Goldwind - H	2208 HK	OW	12.00	7.5	60.3	8,552	22.9	9.1	7.2	0.6	0.6	3.5	4.3	76.1	74.7	6.6	7.9	12.2	10.5
Dajin - H	1081 HK	OW	43.00	22.5	90.8	4,134	11.6	11.0	8.9	0.9	0.9	0.9	1.1	(33.4)	(17.4)	10.3	10.1	13.8	11.9
H-share - Average								**10.0**	**8.0**	**0.8**	**0.7**	**2.2**	**2.7**	**21.3**	**28.6**	**8.4**	**9.0**	**13.0**	**11.2**
Goldwind - A	002202 CH	N	18.00	15.1	18.9	8,552	305.9	21.6	17.1	1.4	1.3	1.5	1.8	76.1	74.7	6.6	7.9	12.2	10.5
Orient Cables	603606 CH	OW	52.00	34.1	52.3	4,216	91.6	17.2	13.9	3.0	2.6	1.8	2.2	16.8	16.8	20.4	21.6	10.7	8.9
Dajin - A	002487 CH	OW	47.00	34.7	35.6	4,134	267.2	19.9	16.0	1.7	1.5	0.5	0.6	(33.4)	(17.4)	10.3	10.1	13.8	11.9
Mingyang	601615 CH	N	10.00	8.8	14.3	2,963	75.4	49.1	28.4	0.7	0.7	1.0	1.8	10.0	10.0	3.0	4.1	10.1	8.7
A-share - Average								**26.9**	**18.9**	**1.7**	**1.5**	**1.2**	**1.6**	**17.3**	**21.0**	**10.1**	**10.9**	**11.7**	**10.0**
China Hydro Power																			
Chuantou	600674 CH	N	16.00	17.3	(7.7)	12,655	74.4	17.3	16.8	1.8	1.7	2.5	2.6	24.9	20.1	10.5	10.2	34.9	31.9
SDIC	600886 CH	N	15.00	16.1	(6.8)	19,283	70.5	17.6	17.5	1.8	1.7	3.2	3.3	129.1	120.8	10.2	9.8	10.8	10.5
Yangtze Power	600900 CH	OW	32.40	29.7	9.1	108,766	456.7	20.1	19.6	3.1	3.0	3.5	3.6	105.6	89.5	15.9	15.6	12.7	12.0
Huaneng Hydro	600025 CH	N	9.00	10.5	(14.0)	29,178	45.0	23.6	23.2	2.6	2.5	1.9	2.0	114.3	105.9	9.8	9.5	14.5	14.4
Average								***19.6***	***19.3***	***2.3***	***2.2***	***2.8***	***2.8***	***93.5***	***84.1***	***11.6***	***11.3***	***18.2***	***17.2***
China Nuclear Power																			
CGN	1816 HK	OW	4.50	3.3	35.7	31,570	17.3	15.0	13.5	1.1	1.0	2.8	3.1	159.3	158.5	8.3	8.8	13.5	12.8
China Solar																			
Xinyi Solar	968 HK	OW	2.8	1.9	48.5	2,194	15.5	36.4	8.6	0.6	0.6	1.3	5.7	19.2	8.8	1.3	5.6	9.6	5.8
Flat Glass	6865 HK	OW	8.8	5.2	69.2	2,858	3.1	NA	8.7	0.5	0.4	0.0	3.4	11.2	5.1	(0.7)	5.2	6.1	6.8
GCL Tech	3800 HK	OW	1.1	0.6	73.2	2,602	25.8	NA	14.5	0.4	0.4	0.0	1.4	20.7	12.5	(1.8)	3.2	8.0	4.1
Daqo	DQ US	OW	22.0	10.1	117.6	684	10.6	NA	51.4	0.1	0.1	0.0	0.0	(15.6)	(17.9)	(3.0)	0.3	66.5	4.7
ADR & H-share - Average								**36.4**	**20.8**	**0.4**	**0.4**	**0.3**	**2.6**	**8.9**	**2.1**	**(1.0)**	**3.6**	**22.5**	**5.4**
Tongwei	600438 CH	UW	8.8	11.3	(21.8)	7,583	90.7	NA	NA	1.7	1.8	0.0	0.0	139.6	128.4	(25.2)	(6.5)	30.9	9.2
LONGi Green	601012 CH	N	11.6	11.0	5.9	12,424	156.2	NA	NA	1.6	1.5	0.0	0.2	(33.1)	(36.8)	(2.1)	1.8	5.8	6.0
Hangzhou First	603806 CH	N	15.0	13.2	14.0	5,140	51.8	27.4	22.6	2.0	1.9	1.9	2.3	0.1	(2.0)	7.5	8.7	19.4	15.8
Sungrow	300274 CH	OW	140.0	76.0	84.1	23,603	755.7	11.0	10.9	2.7	2.3	2.3	2.3	(48.6)	(53.2)	27.6	23.1	9.6	9.5
Deye	605117 CH	OW	154.0	70.2	119.4	13,383	174.7	16.2	12.7	6.8	5.4	3.1	3.9	(18.6)	(27.7)	47.3	47.4	22.8	17.6
Maxwell	300751 CH	UW	120.0	142.8	(16.0)	5,963	195.1	61.5	31.3	4.8	4.3	0.3	0.6	(24.2)	(1.4)	8.0	14.5	40.5	27.0
Shenzhen SC	300724 CH	N	53.0	50.0	6.0	2,606	71.1	17.1	18.6	1.2	1.2	0.9	0.9	(78.7)	(87.2)	7.4	6.4	7.3	7.0
Arctech	688408 CH	OW	40.0	21.1	89.3	693	12.9	29.5	9.1	1.1	1.0	0.9	3.0	28.0	47.5	10.7	15.3	9.6	7.6
Envicool	002837 CH	UW	40.0	44.8	(10.8)	8,574	390.0	76.2	54.5	14.4	12.1	0.4	0.6	(12.8)	(11.2)	20.2	24.1	75.3	59.0
A-share - Average								**33.9**	**20.4**	**2.1**	**2.0**	**0.7**	**1.2**	**5.3**	**8.1**	**1.0**	**6.7**	**18.9**	**12.1**

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P., J.P. Morgan estimates. * FY26E/27E used for China Gas, fiscal year-end 31 March. All prices as of 20 October 2026 market close, except for DQ US, priced as of 19 October 2026.

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